

PENAL LEGION SQUAD

DESPERATE, DAMNED, DISPOSABLE

ASTRA MILITARUM • PENAL LEGION • IMPERIUM

Half the squad were murderers before the press-gang arrived. The other half were just unlucky. The Custodian Sergeant carries a shock-maul that doubles as their detonator key.

No invulnerable save (flak armour). Squad of 10 models.

M	T	SV	W	LD	OC
6"	3	5+	1	8+	2

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	BS	S	AP	D
Laspistol	12"	1	4+	3	0	1
Autogun (Custodian Sergeant)	24"	2	4+	3	0	1
Shotgun (3 models)	12"	2	4+	4	0	1
Grenade launcher (1 model)	24"	1	4+	5	0	1

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	WS	S	AP	D
Improvised CCW	Melee	2	4+	3	0	1
Shock maul (Custodian Sergeant)	Melee	3	3+	5	-1	1

ABILITIES

Autogun

[RAPID FIRE 2]

Shotgun

[ASSAULT]

Grenade launcher

[ANTI-INFANTRY 4+]

Shock maul

[ANTI-INFANTRY 4+]

Explosive Collars

Each model in this unit wears a remotely-triggered explosive collar. This unit automatically passes Battle-shock tests and cannot Fall Back. If the Custodian Sergeant is destroyed by an enemy attack, roll one D6 at the end of the phase: on a 4+, the surviving Convicts go berserk and gain +1 Attack and the [LETHAL HITS] ability until the start of your next turn, then are removed from the battlefield.

Desperadoes

At the start of each of your turns, roll one D6 to determine the squad's mood for the turn: 1-2 Berserk Charge (melee weapons gain [LETHAL HITS]); 3-4 Crack Shots (ranged weapons gain +1 BS); 5-6 Bloodthirsty (melee weapons gain [SUSTAINED HITS 1]).

Press-Ganged

This unit cannot be selected as an army Warlord and cannot be the target of friendly Order abilities except Take Aim! and Fix Bayonets! (or their Officer-issued equivalents).

UNIT COMPOSITION

1 Custodian Sergeant (autogun + shock maul) + 9 Convicts (8 with laspistol + improvised CCW, of which 3 swap their pistol for a shotgun, plus 1 with grenade launcher).

Keywords: INFANTRY, BATTLELINE, PENAL LEGION

Faction Keywords: IMPERIUM, ASTRA MILITARUM

Designer's Note. Penal Legion squads first appeared in 3rd Ed Codex Imperial Guard (1999) and were maintained through 7th Ed Codex Astra Militarum (2014) before being dropped in 8th Ed. The classic identity was three-fold: randomised behaviour each turn via the Desperadoes "psychotic" roll, a Custodian Sergeant who keeps them in line, and explosive collars enforcing morale at the cost of being unable to retreat. This conversion preserves all three, and Press-Ganged restricts Officer synergies to keep the squad feeling like outsiders. **11th-edition verification, 2026-08-31:** checked current 11e BSDData directly — no match for "Penal Legion" anywhere; still genuinely unsupported. No stat corrections possible; kept as-is from the prior 10e conversion pass.